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As cost of government borrowing climbs higher than in Truss crisis,
Rachel Reeves may be forced to cut spending and raise taxes AGAIN

MARKET TURMOIL SOUNDS RED ALERT FOR CHANCELLOR

RACHEL Reeves is drawing up contingency plans for emergency spending cuts or tax rises, as government borrowing costs soar.

Economists said a spike in rates

By **John-Paul Ford Rojas**
and **Jason Groves**

could leave the Chancellor facing a £10 billion-a-year increase in debt interest payments – putting her on course to break her own fiscal rules.

Treasury sources last night acknowl-

edged Ms Reeves could be forced to act as soon as March if sceptical financial markets continue to raise the cost of borrowing.

Tory business spokesman Andrew Griffith said: 'Tragically, the gilt markets can see that the Government's growth plan is dead on arrival.'

'It takes a certain level of incompe-

tence to fiddle your fiscal rules and then still risk missing them.'

In a rare intervention, a spokesman for the Chancellor said her commitment to the fiscal rules was 'non-negotiable'.

A source said Ms Reeves would not wait until the autumn Budget if a new

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